

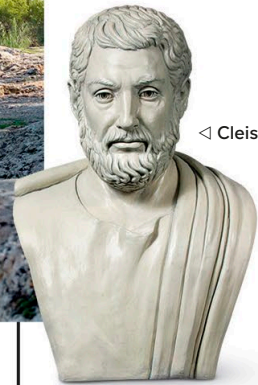
508–507 BCE

ATHENIANS OVERTHROW THE TYRANT HIPPIAS

For more than 100 years, the Greek city-states had been ruled by leaders known as “tyrants” (both good and bad). In Athens, this “Age of Tyrants” came to an end when Hippias was overthrown, and his successor Cleisthenes introduced a form of democracy, in which the Athenian assembly met on a hill called the Pnyx. This heralded the beginning of a “Golden Age” of Classical Greece, with Athens at its centre.



△ The steps of the Pnyx



◁ Cleisthenes

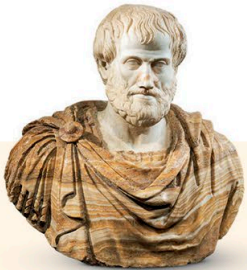
539 BCE Cyrus the Great conquers Babylon and brings its empire into the Achaemenid Empire

525–402 BCE Egypt comes under Persian control and is ruled by Achaemenid kings

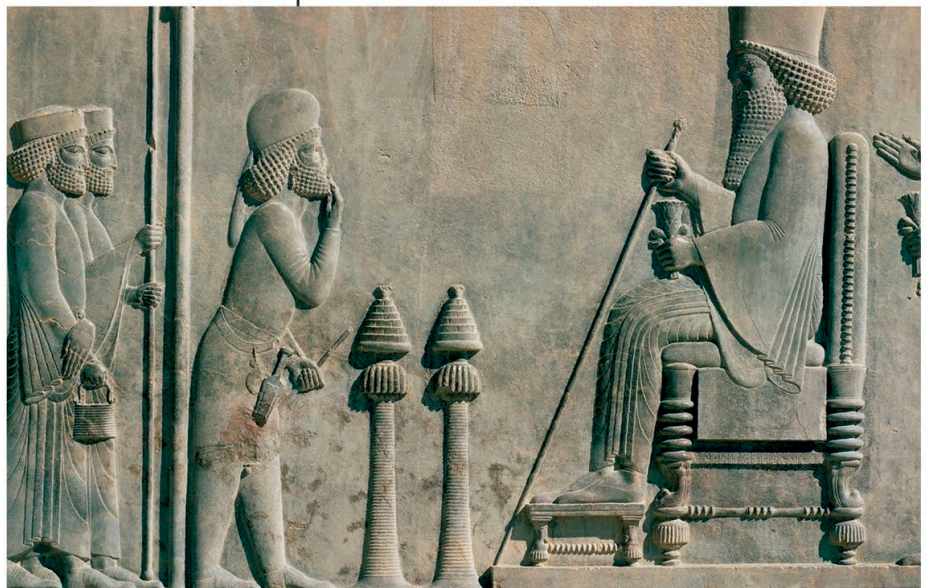
c. 509 BCE The Roman Republic is established following the overthrow of the monarchy

501 BCE

c. 550 BCE Celtic people begin to migrate from their homeland in the northern Alps and settle across Europe



c. 335 BCE Aristotle, an alumnus of the Academy, founds his own school, the Lyceum, offering alternative philosophical theories.



△ Enthronement of Darius, bas-relief

518 BCE

DARIUS THE GREAT BUILDS PERSEPOLIS, HIS NEW CAPITAL

Darius I ruled the Achaemenid Empire at its most powerful, and his 36-year reign included reforms that unified the Persians. He oversaw a number of construction projects, improving roads and regenerating cities; the grandest of these projects was the building of a completely new ceremonial capital, Persepolis, with a complex of impressive palaces.